

Coolness Quotients

Every geek's dream house has not just a top-of-the-line PC, but also all the gaming consoles and cool gadgets...

Robert Sovereign-Smith

A true geek shows off his geekdom (and fat salary as well) by talking about every gadget in his house, not just his PC and cell phone. For them, there's an increasing market for cool consumer electronics.

If you were born before the '80s, you will remember the days when even owning a microwave was considered posh. Today, in the age of iPods, everyone seems to have one of everything. What sets you apart from the crowd is *which* one you have. This applies to everything from microwaves to refrigerators, televisions to air conditioners, and much more.

Odds 'n' Ends

There's always been the devices that have no real purpose, or features that have no business being in a device, and the people who can afford them lap them up with relish! Since we couldn't come up with a name that did this category justice, we decided to call this the Odds 'n' Ends category. Let's take a look at the top three products that we came across, and took a fancy to for some reason or the other.

Multimedia Chair

Let's face it—all of us are couch potatoes at heart! We'd like nothing better than to kick back after a hard day's work (or play) and relax to some serious gaming console action! Or perhaps we'd like to watch a movie, or just chill to our favourite TV series.

Well, now you should be able to do it with style, and loads of comfort to boot. If there's one thing that will get your buddies all green, it's the Hammacher Multimedia Chair.

Yes, as the name suggests, it's a chair *meant* to laze about and

enjoy any type of multimedia content. It has two 50-watt speakers built into the headrest, and promises to envelop you in rich, life-like sound. Whether it's Mozart, a movie, or *F.E.A.R.*, you're sure to love the experience this chair has to offer—not just because it has speakers in the headrest, but because it boasts of a "tactile sound transducer" that actually vibrates the chair realistically according to the woofer's output.

The technology is not new, however, and was first seen in USAF flight simulators and also later in some theme parks and movie theatres.

The good thing is that even at lower volumes, because of the chair's transducer, you will still feel every bump in the road in a racing game, and have a richer movie-watching experience. It will also add a full body experience for those who use game consoles—instead of just tactile feedback for your hands from joysticks, your entire body will feel the recoil of that sniper rifle!

Of course you can control the volume of the 300-watt amplifier as well as the chair's vibrations from a hidden side panel that's within easy reach for the truly lazy. There's a headphone jack for when the family is asleep, and the comfort levels are said to be exquisite—thanks to the suede micro-fibre upholstery, high-density foam and hardwood frame.

Price: \$800 (Rs 36,000)

Coolness Factor: 7/10

URL: www.hammacher.com

PC Desk

So your friend just bought the latest gaming rig. And everyone is trying to outdo everyone else with their configurations. RAM sizes are soaring into the GBs, hard disks are approaching the